STREAMTIME

# Confluent Platform + Streamtime

Enterprise streaming, operated as a fully managed private service

**Pavan Keshavamurthy**

CTO

**Avinash Upadhyaya**

Founding Engineer

Streamtime · November 2026

# Executive Summary

Confluent Platform becomes significantly easier to deploy, operate and scale as a private service.

Confluent Platform brings a mature enterprise streaming stack across Kafka, Connect, Flink, security and governance. Streamtime adds the management plane and 24×7 operating model that turns that stack into a repeatable private service across your estate.

| | |
|---|---|
| **License leverage** | Use existing Confluent Platform entitlements where enterprise features create value, while supporting OSS and alternative SKUs elsewhere. |
| **Deployment leverage** | Encode topology, security integration, observability and lifecycle operations as reusable platform primitives instead of recurring projects. |
| **Operations leverage** | Replace routine platform toil with 24×7 managed SLO ownership, autonomous investigations and controlled upgrades. |
| **Adoption leverage** | Redirect field engineering from basic platform plumbing toward migration, application onboarding, performance and organization-wide adoption. |

Higher return on Confluent Platform, lower professional-services and headcount burden, faster time to production, and one accountable operating model.

Sources: Confluent Platform overview · Streamtime docs

# Confluent Platform + Streamtime

Enterprise capabilities and private infrastructure, joined by a workload-aware management plane.

### Confluent Platform

Kafka
Schema Registry
Connect + connectors
Control Center
Cluster Linking / MRC
RBAC + audit logs
Tiered Storage
Confluent Flink*

→

### Streamtime

Fleet + topology model
Workload-aware APIs
Placement + tenancy
Networking + storage
Observability
Lifecycle operations
Operational context
MCP + agent surfaces

→

### Your estate

Cloud / data center
Kubernetes or VMs
Identity + PKI
DNS + domains
Storage classes
Observability stack
Confluent licenses
Security controls

Your Confluent subscription and entitlements remain intact. Streamtime standardizes how Confluent Platform is deployed and operated across the private estate.

Sources: Confluent licensing · Streamtime Confluent Platform docs

# Productize deployment

Replace repeated implementation projects with one declarative fleet and workload contract.

Much of the work required to stand up Confluent Platform is repeatable: topology, infrastructure, networking, security integration, component configuration, observability, validation, DR and upgrades.

Design → Build → Integrate → Validate → Handover → **Repeat**

## ~5 minutes

**to a production cluster**

The same declarative contract is reusable across supported Confluent topologies and environments.

## $600K / year

**3 FTE minimum dedicated platform team @ $200K**

Illustrative lower-bound staffing cost before SecOps, networking, identity, storage and application coordination.

### Production and DR become repeatable environments

Create secondary / disaster-recovery environments automatically from the same fleet contract, carrying topology, networking, storage, security policy, observability and lifecycle intent into each environment.

Streamtime moves repeatable stand-up, DR and lifecycle work into software. FDE and consulting time can focus on migrations, workload design, performance and adoption.

Sources: Streamtime production-cluster claim · Confluent partner model

# TCO of self-managed

Professional services are only one layer of the cost of operating a private Confluent Platform estate.

Even a lower-end enterprise deployment combines external services, a dedicated platform team and months of cross-functional coordination. Larger estates are usually materially more expensive.

**$3,200**

average professional-services engagement rate / day

**>$150K**

lower-bound enterprise professional-services spend; often much higher

**$600K / year**

3 FTE minimum platform team @ $200K each

| | |
|---|---|
| **Time to production** | ~3 months is a common lower-bound path to the first production cluster once platform, security, identity, networking and change coordination are included. |
| **Hidden coordination cost** | SecOps, PKI, identity, networking, storage, change management and application handoffs add substantial unpriced effort beyond PS and platform-team spend. |

Even at the lower end of enterprise Confluent Platform deployments, Streamtime saves >80% of the operational overhead around the estate by productizing deployment, operations and lifecycle management.

Illustrative lower-bound benchmarks supplied by Streamtime / Platformatory; larger enterprise programs are commonly higher.

STREAMTIME

# Use Confluent where it creates the most value

Match workload criticality and enterprise requirements to the right SKU, while keeping one operating model.

| Workload | Recommended SKU | Why |
|---|---|---|
| **Mission-critical production** | Confluent Platform | Enterprise security, governance, resilience and commercial connectors |
| **Shared dev / test** | Virtual Clusters | Logical multi-tenancy on shared physical capacity |
| **Lower-criticality environments** | Apache Kafka / OSS | Avoid commercial license where enterprise features are unnecessary |
| **High-volume BYOC** | WarpStream | Object-storage-centric Kafka-compatible architecture where appropriate |
| **Stream processing** | Confluent Flink / Apache Flink | Choose by entitlement, features and economics |

Chargeback by workload, team, tenant and environment turns a large Confluent estate into an attributable service. Capacity and licenses can be consolidated instead of drifting into cluster sprawl.

Sources: Confluent license types · Private Cloud multi-tenancy

# Fully managed operations for Confluent Platform

Direct operational ownership, not just escalation support.

Confluent support is case-driven: customers open a request, provide issue detail and supporting diagnostics, and use Confluent guidance to execute remediation in their own environment.

| Confluent support | Streamtime support plans |
| --- | --- |
| Open a case | 24×7 SLO and incident ownership |
| Collect and upload logs / diagnostics | Global Data/SRE teams investigate directly |
| Receive recommended actions | Execute bounded remediation and upgrades |
| Customer team executes and validates | Verify recovery against steady-state baselines |

## Operational insurance against disruption

Streamtime takes responsibility for every covered production incident under the support plan. The same operating model spans health, capacity, maintenance windows, upgrades, recovery and DR environments.




This is the difference between product support and a fully managed private service: Streamtime owns the operational loop and addresses incidents 24×7.

Sources: Confluent support portal · diagnostics bundles · Streamtime managed services

STREAMTIME

# Move services spend up the value chain

Use forward-deployed engineering to accelerate adoption, rather than repeatedly assembling the platform.

Once the platform foundation is productized, field engineering can focus on the work that changes business outcomes.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Migrate** | Kafka / messaging migrations, zero-downtime cutovers, client modernization and connector migration |
| **Adopt** | Reference architectures, paved paths, developer enablement and data-product onboarding |
| **Optimize** | Performance engineering, cost / topology reviews, Flink and Connect design, benchmark-led sizing |
| **Scale** | Operating model, tenancy, chargeback, governance and platform product management |

Use field depth for migrations, use cases, performance and organizational adoption. Keep repeatable deployment and Day 2 work inside the platform.

Sources: Confluent partner programs · Platformatory migration offering

STREAMTIME

# The business case

Increase the return on Confluent Platform by productizing deployment and operations.

**License leverage**

Concentrate commercial entitlements where they create value.

**Services leverage**

Move recurring stand-up and lifecycle work into the platform.

**Headcount leverage**

Replace a permanent specialist platform function with a managed operating model.

**Risk reduction**

Use standard deployment primitives, SLO ownership and controlled upgrades.

**Estate transparency**

Manage tenancy, workload SKUs, chargeback and the private estate from one plane.

**>80%** of recurring operational overhead can be offset by Streamtime even against the lower end of enterprise Confluent Platform deployments, through productized deployment, SLO ownership, autonomous operations and lifecycle automation.

Sources: Confluent Platform docs · Streamtime docs

STREAMTIME

# Confluent Platform, operated as a private managed service.